



REVIEW



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Music in cultural tourism: insights from a dual approach of scoping review and bibliometric analysis

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This study examines the relationship between music and cultural tourism using a dual approach: a scoping review and bibliometric analysis. It explores music's role in cultural preservation, economic development, tourist motivations, and the integration of digital technologies, highlighting key trends, challenges, and opportunities. Peer-reviewed journal articles from the Scopus database were reviewed, and bibliometric analysis was applied to evaluate the studies' impact and identify recurring themes, including cultural preservation, tourist behavior, and technological innovations. The findings reveal that music tourism significantly contributes to cultural preservation, regional identity, and economic growth. However, challenges such as the commodification of heritage, ethical representation of marginalized communities, and unequal access to digital technologies remain underexplored. The study underscores the transformative potential of augmented and virtual reality in music tourism while emphasizing the need for inclusive strategies to ensure authenticity and sustainability. This research is limited to Scopus-indexed articles, with partial bibliometric analysis applied to uncover key themes. Future studies should expand database coverage, utilize advanced bibliometric tools, and examine the long-term effects of digital innovations on music tourism. By integrating scoping and bibliometric methods, this study offers a nuanced understanding of the interplay between music and cultural tourism, identifies critical gaps, and provides actionable insights for advancing sustainable and inclusive practices in the field.

Introduction

Tourism is a powerful cultural and economic force, contributing significantly to local economies while fostering cultural exchange (Cherbo et al., 2008; Dwyer, 2015; Gotham, 2002; Lin et al., 2021; Richards, 2019). Among its various forms, cultural tourism has emerged as a dominant theme, attracting individuals seeking deeper engagement with local traditions and heritage (Bolderman et al., 2018; Caciora et al., 2021; Liberato et al., 2024; Smith, 2015). Within the realm of cultural tourism, music plays a particularly prominent role, both as

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an intangible cultural asset and as a key driver of tourism (Bugeja, 2012; Gibson & Connell, 2003; Henshall, 2012). Music tourism, a subset of cultural tourism, plays a crucial role in this dynamic. However, as music is increasingly commodified for tourism purposes, tensions arise between cultural preservation and commercialization, particularly in contexts where marginalized or indigenous communities are involved (Argyriadis, 2008; Mason, 2004). This growing challenge underscores the need for research that examines how music tourism can balance economic demands with the ethical responsibility to preserve cultural authenticity. As tourism transforms traditional music into a commercial product, the line between preservation and commodification becomes increasingly blurred (Argyriadis, 2008; Fernandes, 2013).

This tension between cultural preservation and commercialization is particularly evident in destinations where music is deeply embedded in the local culture but is also marketed to tourists as a packaged experience (Ibrahim et al., 2022; Jaeni, 2023; Richards, 2019). For example, the commodification of Afro-Cuban religious music for tourism in Cuba reflects the complexities of balancing cultural authenticity with the economic demands of the tourism industry (Argyriadis, 2008). These ethical challenges underscore the need for a more critical examination of how music tourism impacts local cultures, particularly in terms of preserving cultural identity while meeting the demands of global tourism markets (Cherbo et al., 2008; Dunbar-Hall, 2001; Gibson & Connell, 2003; Li et al., 2022).

At the same time, music tourism is becoming increasingly integrated with emerging technologies such as virtual reality (VR) and augmented reality (AR), which are transforming how tourists experience music and cultural heritage (Han et al., 2019; Huang & Chiao, 2018; Loureiro, 2020; Safian et al., 2024). These technologies have the potential to enhance the authenticity of tourist experiences while offering innovative methods to safeguard cultural heritage. For instance, Ozdemir, (2021), highlighted that VR and AR can boost destination market, enhancing customer experience with the immersive experience that simulate real-life interactions and cultural experiences. Additionally, Kečkeš & Tomić (2017) mentioned that VR can also improve accessibility in tourism, especially for individual with disabilities and those who are unable to visit physically. Beck et al. (2019), focuses on AR's ability to enhance tourist engagement by providing interactive content, such as real-time translations, enhanced historical context, and personalized experiences.

Apart from that, recent studies provide specific applications of AR in preserving and promoting music and cultural heritage. For example, Hong & Wu (2022) developed an AR application tailored to introduce traditional Chinese musical instruments from the Guizhou province, aiming to popularize these instruments among youth and tourists. The app, tested by students from Guizhou Minzu University, demonstrated its ability to intensify users' connection with national musical identity, with 89% reporting increased inspiration and involvement, and 93% showing heightened interest in learning. This case underscores how AR can merge educational and tourism objectives to create deeper cultural engagement while promoting local traditions as part of an integrated national tourism strategy. Similarly, audio AR systems are proving to be valuable in urban tourism contexts.

This study addresses these gaps by conducting a scoping review and bibliometric analysis of music tourism literature, which forms the core novelty of this research. Through a systematic synthesis of key findings from academic studies, this literature review examines the role of music in cultural tourism, highlights its contributions to cultural and economic development, and identifies critical gaps that guide further exploration.

Literature review

The literature on music and cultural tourism explores the multifaceted role of music in shaping cultural identities, attracting tourists, and contributing to regional development. This section synthesizes key findings from diverse academic perspectives, focusing on music's economic impact, its role in preserving cultural heritage, and its influence on tourist motivations. The review also critically examines the commodification of music within the tourism industry and explores how festivals, events, and digital innovations are transforming the music tourism landscape. By identifying gaps in the current research, this review sets the foundation for further exploration of ethical, cultural, and technological implications within the field.

Overview of music and cultural tourism. The relationship between music and cultural tourism has been widely documented, with scholars emphasizing music's pivotal role in enriching cultural experiences, preserving heritage, and fostering regional economic growth (Aoyama, 2009; Dunbar-Hall, 2001; García et al., 2003; Mazlan et al., 2024, 2025a, 2025b; Ramdan et al., 2024). Music serves as both a cultural product and a medium for cultural expression, offering tourists opportunities to engage with authentic and immersive local traditions. Across diverse global contexts, music acts as a cultural catalyst, shaping regional branding and identity, while influencing tourism trends at local and international levels (Mason, 2004; Ryan, 2015). In Croatia, for example, music valorization has been identified as a critical factor in cultural tourism, although its strategic integration remains underdeveloped. Grgurić & Stipanović (2021) conducted an in-depth analysis of the role of sound and music in Croatian tourism, proposing innovations centered on audio management models. Their findings suggest that, despite the recognition of music's potential to enhance cultural and tourist experiences, it is insufficiently leveraged as a strategic tool to maximize its impact. They emphasize the importance of diversifying musical offerings and creating integrated tourism products through stakeholder collaboration at both micro and macro levels. This underscores the need for strategic planning to fully capitalize on the role of music in cultural tourism and to enhance its contribution to regional development.

Cultural preservation and identity. Music tourism contributes significantly to cultural preservation by providing platforms for local traditions to thrive. For instance, flamenco performances in Andalusia (Aoyama, 2009) and Balinese music and dance (Dunbar-Hall, 2001) demonstrate how tourism can reinforce regional identities while showcasing cultural heritage. However, these practices often face challenges related to commodification, as highlighted by Argyriadis (2008) in the context of Afro-Cuban religious music, where the pressures of tourism markets conflict with cultural authenticity.

Similarly, Mason (2004) critiques how Aboriginal music tourism in Canada perpetuates cultural stereotypes, raising ethical concerns about the representation of indigenous traditions. These examples underscore the tension between cultural preservation and commercialization, a recurring theme in music tourism. Following that, Fernandes (2013) highlights how world music can also function as a marketing tool for territories, emphasizing that music's association with specific places can enhance a region's attractiveness as a tourism destination. In Tasmania, for instance, Ryan (2015) notes that music has played a central role in rebranding the region and reshaping its cultural identity, creating a new image for the local community that resonates with both domestic and international tourists. These

examples underscore the tension between cultural preservation and commercialization, a recurring theme in music tourism.

Economic and ethical impacts. Music tourism often serves as an economic driver, generating revenue and creating opportunities for local and regional development. Traditional Scottish music festivals, as studied by McMorland & Mactaggart (2007), and flamenco shows in Córdoba García et al. (2003) highlight how music tourism supports local businesses and cultural institutions. Similarly, the Guča trumpet festival in Serbia (Gligorić, 2014) and Cape Breton's music tourism cluster in Canada (Brown & Geddes, 2007) exemplify how music fosters regional economic diversification.

Despite these benefits, the commodification of music raises ethical challenges, particularly for marginalized and indigenous communities whose cultural expressions are often repackaged for tourist consumption. Argyriadis (2008) critiques the commercialization of Afro-Cuban religious music, while Fernandes (2013) argues that world music is frequently exploited as a marketing tool, overshadowing its cultural significance. Addressing these ethical concerns is critical for ensuring sustainable and inclusive tourism practices.

Technological innovation and music tourism. Digital technologies, particularly augmented reality (AR) and virtual reality (VR), are transforming music tourism by creating immersive and interactive experiences. For example, Hong & Wu (2022) developed an AR application to introduce traditional Chinese musical instruments to tourists and students, demonstrating how AR can enhance cultural preservation while engaging younger audiences. Similarly, the *AudioNear* system (Boletsis & Chasanidou, 2018) uses audio AR to provide tourists with real-time information about their surroundings, blending cultural education with interactive exploration.

However, these innovations also pose challenges. While AR and VR expand accessibility and modernize tourism experiences, they risk oversimplifying cultural narratives or excluding local practitioners from digital representation (Huang & Chiao, 2018). The equitable adoption of these technologies, particularly in under-represented regions, remains a significant area for further research.

Tourist motivation. Tourists are motivated to engage with music tourism for various reasons, including cultural appreciation, social interaction, and the pursuit of authenticity. McMorland & Mactaggart (2007) found that native Scots attending local music festivals were driven by a sense of cultural pride, while Mallette et al. (2018) noted that audience segmentation at military music festivals revealed motivations tied to patriotism and national identity. In contrast, Mason (2004) examined how Aboriginal music tourism can challenge and reinforce cultural stereotypes, influencing tourist perceptions and motivations. Understanding these diverse motivations is crucial for designing tourism experiences that foster meaningful cultural engagement. By appealing to a wide range of motivations, event organizers can create inclusive and impactful music tourism experiences.

Festivals and events. Festivals and events serve as central pillars of music tourism, offering tourists immersive experiences of local culture. Herrero et al. (2012) emphasize the dual economic and cultural value of festivals, noting their role in generating revenue and preserving traditions. Government-led initiatives, such as Macao's musical events (Io, 2019), highlight how state-sponsored festivals promote cultural heritage while providing entertainment for tourists. Trandafoiu (2024) demonstrates

how electronic dance music (EDM) festivals in Romania simultaneously foster cultural identity and economic vitality, reshaping the country's tourism landscape. Nevertheless, the commercialization of festivals often raises concerns about cultural authenticity. Cashman (2014), discusses the commodification of music on cruise ships, where performances are tailored to tourist expectations rather than preserving cultural integrity. Similarly, Argyriadis (2008), critiques the commercialization of Afro-Cuban music, calling for more balanced approaches to cultural tourism.

Critical examination. While the literature reveals the broad significance of music in cultural tourism, it also exposes some limitations. Although the economic and cultural benefits of music tourism are well-documented, few studies critically examine the ethical implications of commodifying cultural heritage through music. Argyriadis (2008) is one of the few scholars to address the tensions between cultural preservation and commercialization, specifically in the context of Afro-Cuban music. This ethical dimension is underexplored, particularly concerning indigenous and marginalized communities whose music is often commodified for tourist consumption without adequate attention to cultural sensitivity.

Additionally, the role of digital technologies in shaping music tourism experiences is another gap in the literature. While studies like those of Huang & Chiao (2018) discuss the potential of digital tools such as VR and AR in tourism, the impact of these technologies on the authenticity and sustainability of music tourism experiences remains under-researched. This is an area that requires further academic attention, especially as tourism increasingly incorporates digital experiences.

Synthesis of key findings. In summary, literature highlights music's role in promoting cultural tourism by driving economic growth, preserving cultural identities, and influencing tourist motivations. However, the commercialization of music for tourism purposes raises concerns about cultural authenticity and ethical considerations. Future research should address these gaps, particularly by exploring the long-term sustainability of music tourism and the effects of digital innovations on the tourist experience.

Methodology

This study employs a scoping review to systematically explore the intersection of music and cultural tourism, complemented by bibliometric analysis to quantitatively assess trends and key studies. The research follows the five-stage framework of Arksey & O'Malley (2005), adapted for this study's interdisciplinary focus.

• Scoping Review Process

• Identifying the Research Question

The study aims to address the question: *What are the key themes, challenges, and emerging trends in music tourism research?* The formulation of this question is to ensure rigor and consistency in the review approach (Peters et al., 2020).

• Identifying Relevant Studies

To ensure a comprehensive and systematic search of relevant literature, Scopus was selected as the primary database for this review. Scopus is widely recognized for its extensive coverage of multidisciplinary academic content, offering a broad range of high-quality peer-reviewed journal articles (Falagas et al., 2008). The decision to use Scopus was supported by several factors:

- **Comprehensive Multidisciplinary Coverage**
Scopus includes journals across diverse fields, making it particularly suitable for exploring an interdisciplinary topic such as music tourism, which intersects cultural studies, tourism, and technology. Its comprehensive journal inclusion policy ensures broad coverage across disciplines, facilitating the identification of relevant studies in emerging fields (Mongeon & Paul-Hus, 2016; Visser et al., 2021).
- **Quality and Reliability**
Scopus indexes only peer-reviewed journals, ensuring the inclusion of high-quality and reliable sources. This is achieved through its rigorous content selection process and periodic evaluation by an independent advisory board (Baas et al., 2020). It consistently includes journals with high standards of quality and impact, making it a trusted database for scoping reviews that prioritize credible evidence (Aksnes & Sivertsen, 2019).
- **Sophisticated Search Capabilities**
Scopus allows advanced filtering and querying options, enabling precise identification of articles based on specific criteria, such as document type, publication stage, and language. Its tools for analyzing search results, such as citation overviews and export options, further enhance its usability (Alryalat et al., 2019). This ensures a transparent and reproducible aspect for scoping review. This aligns with the principles of scoping reviews to identify a wide range of evidence, as highlighted by Borgohain et al. (2022).
- **Relevance for Analysis**
Scopus is widely used in bibliometric studies due to its robust citation metrics and analysis tools, such as h-index computation and visualization features for interdisciplinary impact assessment (Chadegani et al., 2013). In addition to bibliometric analysis, its citation data supports detailed mapping of research trends. This is crucial in scoping reviews for understanding the evolution of a topic and identifying seminal works, as demonstrated by Chen (2017) and Vaidya et al. (2021).
- **Studies selection**
The search strategy included combinations of terms such as “cultural tourism” and “music,” with additional filters applied to limit the results to peer-reviewed journal articles published in English. No specific time frame was imposed, allowing the review to capture developments in the field over multiple decades. This approach aligns with best practices in scoping reviews, which aim to map comprehensive trends and include a wide breadth of evidence (Chen, 2017). An initial search yielded 84 records, which were subsequently subjected to a screening process based on predefined inclusion and exclusion criteria. The inclusion criteria required studies to focus specifically on the role of music within cultural tourism and be published in English-language peer-reviewed journals. Studies that were unrelated to music in cultural tourism or published as conference papers, book chapters, or non-peer-reviewed sources were excluded. Following this process, a total of 40 articles were selected for detailed analysis. This follows the recommendations of established frameworks for scoping reviews, emphasizing predefined criteria for transparency and consistency (Levac et al., 2010; Tricco et al., 2016). The step-by-step study selection process is illustrated in Fig. 1 below, which provides a clear depiction of the inclusion and exclusion criteria applied throughout the review.
- **Charting the Data: Combining Scoping and Bibliometric Approaches**
The data charting process was carried out in two stages. In the first stage, bibliometric charting was performed. Bibliometric measures were applied to evaluate the scholarly impact of the selected articles. This included analyzing citation dynamics within the field, identifying influential authors, and highlighting frequently cited studies. Bibliometric analyses are frequently used to provide quantitative insights into the evolution of research and to map key contributions to specific fields (Álvarez-García et al., 2019; Lim & Kumar, 2024; Rivest et al., 2021; Vaidya et al., 2021; Van Leeuwen et al., 2001). In the second stage, thematic charting was conducted as part of the scoping review. Articles were systematically charted based on specific attributes, such as authors, title, aim, study design, and key themes. Thematic charting allows for the systematic mapping of themes within the literature, which is critical for scoping reviews aiming to explore a research field comprehensively (Peters et al., 2020; Tricco et al., 2016).
- **Collecting, summarizing and reporting result**
The combination of scoping review and bibliometric analysis resulted in a dual-layered reporting structure. The bibliometric analysis provided a quantitative perspective on the scholarly impact and influence of the reviewed studies, helping to contextualize which authors, studies, and themes have shaped the field. Simultaneously, the thematic analysis offered a qualitative overview of the key trends and themes that emerged within the literature on music and cultural tourism. Thematic analysis been highlighted as a critical step for identifying recurring concepts and categorizing evidence in scoping (Finkelstein et al., 2021; Levac et al., 2010; Mazlan et al., 2023, 2025a, 2025b; Ramdan et al., 2024; Tricco et al., 2016; Yahaya et al., 2022). This combined approach ensured both a comprehensive exploration of the literature and a robust quantitative assessment of the field’s scholarly impact. It allowed for the identification of key contributors and thematic clusters while offering insights into how music influences the broader discourse on cultural tourism. This dual-method approach has been shown to enhance the depth and breadth of literature reviews by combining quantitative trends with qualitative insights (Amin et al., 2022).
- **Bibliometric Analysis Process**
The bibliometric analysis was conducted using *biblioMajika* version 2.9, a bibliometric tool created by Ahmi (2024). This tool allowed for transparency and replicability by providing standardized outputs that could be cross-verified with existing bibliographic databases (Nour El Huda et al., 2023; Panchal & Chand, 2024; Rajab et al., 2024; Zhang et al., 2024). While the scoping review, as abovementioned, provided a comprehensive mapping of the literature (Hayashi et al., 2022; Iliev, 2020; Jette et al., 2017; Mazlan et al., 2023; Wahid et al., 2024; Yahaya et al., 2022), bibliometric analysis was integrated to offer a

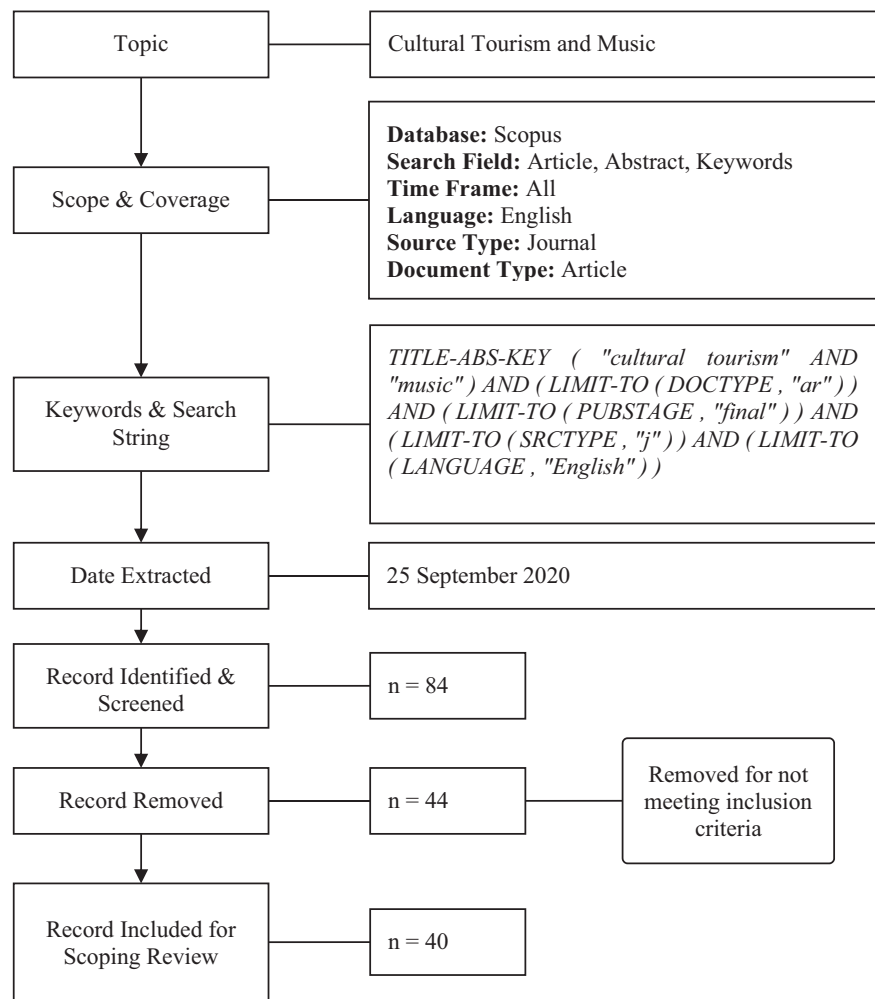


Fig. 1 Flow diagram of the search strategy for this scoping review. Source: Moher et al. (2009), Zakaria et al. (2021).

quantitative assessment of the impact and influence of the selected studies. In this study, the bibliometric analysis aspect focused on:

- Citation metrics: Total citations and citations per year were analyzed to gauge the scholarly impact of individual studies, revealing how specific articles have shaped the field over time. These metrics are widely recognized for identifying influential research in bibliometric studies (Chen, 2017; Egghe, 2006; Guerrero-Gironés et al., 2022; Mongeon & Paul-Hus, 2016).
- Author Impact: The h-index and g-index were employed to evaluate the productivity and citation impact of authors, offering insights into the contribution of key figures within the field. These indices have been shown to provide robust measures of scholarly influence (Bornmann & Daniel, 2007; Chadegani et al., 2013; Egghe, 2006; Hirsch, 2005).

The next section presents the results of the combined scoping review and bibliometric analysis, offering insights into document profiles, publication trends, highly cited works, and the data charting matrix. These elements collectively highlight the key themes that emerged from the selected studies.

Results

This section presents findings derived from both selective bibliometric analysis and a scoping review. The bibliometric analysis

covers essential metrics such as publication trends, citation counts, and key citation indices (h-index, g-index, m-index) across the dataset from 2001 to 2024. Additionally, the scoping review is used to identify and analyze the key themes emerging from the literature on music and cultural tourism. The results highlight patterns of scholarly productivity, the influence of highly cited documents, and thematic areas such as economic impact, cultural preservation, and the role of festivals and events. This combined approach provides a detailed understanding of the scholarly landscape and thematic developments, setting the foundation for the subsequent discussion.

Documents profile. Table 1 below presents citation metrics for documents published between 2001 and 2024. Firstly, the total number of publications during this period is 46, with 24 being citable years. This means that the citation metrics cover nearly two and a half decades of academic contributions. Moreover, the number of contributing authors totals 110, suggesting a robust level of collaboration. In terms of cited papers, 41 papers from this dataset have been cited, leading to a cumulative total of 659 citations. On average, this yields approximately 14.33 citations per paper, indicating that each paper, on average, receives a significant amount of attention in the field. Additionally, when considering citations per cited paper, the figure rises to 16.07, meaning that once a paper is cited, it tends to accumulate a higher number of citations than the overall average.

Furthermore, the citation rate per year is 28.65, highlighting the consistent citation of these publications over time. Regarding

Table 1 Citation Metrics.	
Main Information	Data
Publication Years	2001-2024
Total Publications	46
Citable Year	24
Number of Contributing Authors	110
Number of Cited Papers	41
Total Citations	659
Citation per Paper	14.33
Citation per Cited Paper	16.07
Citation per Year	28.65
Citation per Author	5.99
Author per Paper	2.39
Citation sum within h-Core	656
h-index	14
g-index	24
m-index	0.583
Source: Generated by the author(s) using biblioMagika® (Ahmi, 2024)	

Table 2 Subject area.		
Subject Area	Total Publications	Percentage (%)
Social Sciences	27	58.70%
Business, Management and Accounting	25	54.35%
Arts and Humanities	14	30.43%
Environmental Science	6	13.04%
Computer Science	3	6.52%
Economics, Econometrics and Finance	3	6.52%
Engineering	3	6.52%
Agricultural and Biological Sciences	2	4.35%
Earth and Planetary Sciences	2	4.35%
Energy	2	4.35%
Mathematics	1	2.17%
Nursing	1	2.17%
Physics and Astronomy	1	2.17%
Source: Generated by the author(s) using biblioMagika® (Ahmi, 2024)		

individual authors, the average citation per author stands at 5.99, showing that contributions are widely acknowledged across the author base. Each author, on average, has contributed to 2.39 papers, indicating a moderate level of repeated authorship within the dataset. Importantly, the citation sum within the h-core, a metric that indicates the highly influential core of papers—totals 656, showing that most of the total citations come from this core group of papers. The h-index of 14 means that at least 14 papers have been cited 14 or more times, which reflects both the productivity and impact of these publications. In addition, the g-index of 24 suggests that the top 24 articles cumulatively have more citations, which balances the h-index by accounting for highly cited papers. Finally, the m-index of 0.583 offers a normalized measure of the h-index, which considers the publication career length and indicates steady academic productivity.

Next, Table 2 below provides an overview of the total publications across various subject areas and their corresponding percentage contributions to the dataset. Firstly, most publications fall under the Social Sciences, with 27 publications, accounting for 58.70% of the total. This indicates that more than half of the

Table 3 Publication by year.									
Year	TP	NCA	NCP	TC	C/P	C/CP	h	g	m
2001	1	1	1	38	38.00	38.00	1	1	0.042
2004	1	1	1	56	56.00	56.00	1	1	0.048
2006	1	2	1	56	56.00	56.00	1	1	0.053
2007	3	7	3	95	31.67	31.67	3	3	0.167
2008	1	1	1	4	4.00	4.00	1	1	0.059
2009	4	9	4	96	24.00	24.00	4	4	0.250
2011	2	3	2	10	5.00	5.00	2	2	0.143
2012	3	6	3	99	33.00	33.00	3	3	0.231
2013	2	3	2	4	2.00	2.00	2	2	0.167
2014	5	10	5	73	14.60	14.60	5	5	0.455
2016	2	4	2	11	5.50	5.50	2	2	0.222
2017	1	2	1	3	3.00	3.00	1	1	0.125
2018	5	12	3	16	3.20	5.33	2	4	0.286
2019	3	4	3	25	8.33	8.33	3	3	0.500
2020	1	5	1	6	6.00	6.00	1	1	0.200
2021	3	7	2	16	5.33	8.00	1	3	0.250
2022	4	12	4	40	10.00	10.00	3	4	1.000
2023	2	5	1	10	5.00	10.00	1	2	0.500
2024	2	16	1	1	0.50	1.00	1	1	1.000
Total	46	110	41	659	14.33	16.07	14	24	0.583
TP total number of publications, NCA Number of contributing authors; NCP number of cited publications; TC total citations; C/P average citations per publication; C/CP average citations per cited publication; h = h-index; g = g-index; m = m-index. Source: Generated by the author(s) using biblioMagika® (Ahmi, 2024)									

research focus is centered on social sciences topics, highlighting the prominence of this field within the dataset.

Following this, Business, Management, and Accounting represents the second-largest subject area, with 25 publications, contributing to 54.35% of the total. This suggests a significant overlap or close relationship between social sciences and business-related research.

Additionally, Arts and Humanities occupies the third position with 14 publications, making up 30.43% of the total. This shows a notable academic interest in cultural and artistic aspects, possibly linked to the thematic focus of music and cultural tourism in the research. Moreover, other fields like Environmental Science (13.04%) and Computer Science (6.52%) are represented with smaller yet relevant contributions.

Interestingly, Economics, Econometrics, and Finance, along with Engineering, each have 3 publications, representing 6.52% of the total, indicating a cross-disciplinary exploration involving economic and technical dimensions. Furthermore, subject areas like Agricultural and Biological Sciences, Earth and Planetary Sciences, and Energy each have 2 publications, contributing 4.35% each, reflecting niche but significant research interests. Finally, subject areas such as Mathematics, Nursing, and Physics and Astronomy have a smaller representation, each with 1 publication, contributing 2.17%. Although these fields have a lower percentage, their inclusion suggests that the research scope encompasses a broad range of academic disciplines.

Publication trends. Table 3 below provides a detailed breakdown of publication metrics over the years, revealing the trends in scholarly productivity, citation patterns, and author contribution. Firstly, the dataset spans from 2001 to 2024, capturing 46 total publications (TP). The number of contributing authors (NCA) totals 110, indicating a broad collaborative effort across multiple years. It is worth noting that the publication activity has not been evenly distributed throughout the years, with certain years exhibiting a noticeable concentration of output. For example, 2006 and 2007 each show high citation counts, with 56 total citations (TC) in both years. Notably, these publications had high average

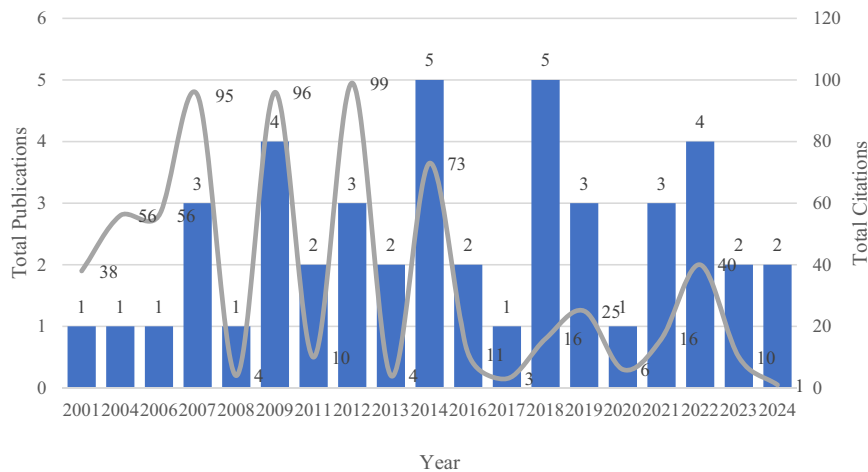


Fig. 2 Total publications and citations by year. Source: Generated by the author(s) using biblioMagika® (Ahmi, 2024).

citation counts per publication (C/P), with a value of 56.00 in each year, demonstrating the significant academic impact of the work published during this time. However, the h-index for these years remains modest at 1, reflecting that while the papers were highly cited, the breadth of citation across multiple papers remained limited.

Moving further, the year 2009 marks a distinct drop in both publication count and total citations, with only 4 total citations. This trend continues through 2012, where the citation activity remains low, averaging 4.00 citations per publication during this period. In contrast, a surge in productivity and impact occurs in 2014, with 13 total citations and a C/P ratio of 14.60. This suggests that work published in this year gained notable scholarly attention. Moreover, recent years, particularly 2019 and 2023, exhibit a strong increase in both publications and citations. In 2019, there were 4 publications, each averaging 25.83 citations, leading to a C/CP (average citations per cited publication) of 33.00, highlighting the scholarly significance of the work from this year. Similarly, in 2023, despite having 2 publications, the average citations per paper (C/P) reached 16.50, indicating their relevance and influence within the academic community. In terms of author collaboration, the number of contributing authors (NCA) also varies significantly over the years, with 2016 and 2023 exhibiting higher levels of author collaboration, as indicated by NCA values of 4 and 6, respectively. This suggests an increase in multidisciplinary and collaborative research in more recent years.

Additionally, when looking at h-index, g-index, and m-index, we observe that the overall h-index of the dataset is 14, indicating that 14 papers have received at least 14 citations each, demonstrating both productivity and impact. The g-index is higher at 24, reflecting that the top 24 papers have collectively accumulated a high number of citations. The m-index of 0.583 suggests a steady citation rate relative to the duration of the publications' existence. In summary, the data in Table 3 illustrates a fluctuating but ultimately growing trend in both publication output and scholarly impact. Particularly, the years 2006, 2007, 2014, 2019, and 2023 stand out as years of high academic impact, characterized by significant citation activity. The metrics also reflect increased author collaboration in recent years, aligning with broader trends in interdisciplinary research.

To further support Table 3, Fig. 2 provides a visual representation of the total number of publications and citations by year from 2001 to 2024, offering a clearer understanding of the trends in both scholarly output and citation impact. The blue bars represent the total publications per year, while the grey line

highlights the corresponding citation counts, giving insight into both the quantity and influence of the research produced. Firstly, the early years of the dataset, from 2001 to 2007, show a steady yet low publication output of 1 publication per year. However, despite the low publication volume, certain years, particularly 2006 and 2007, exhibit notably high citation counts (56 citations each), indicating that even a limited number of works during this period had significant academic influence.

Moving forward, 2009 stands out with a sharp peak of 95 citations, despite having only 1 publication that year. This suggests that the work published in 2009 had a profound impact on its respective field. In contrast, the following years (2010–2012) experience a significant decline, both in terms of publications and citations. 2012 sees just 4 citations from 1 publication, representing one of the lower points in the dataset's impact. The trend reverses in 2014, where there is a marked increase in both publication output (3 publications) and citations (73 citations). This upward trajectory continues into 2015 and 2016, which shows the highest publication counts with 5 publications per year. Interestingly, while the number of publications in this period is high, the citation counts remain more moderate, suggesting that these works may have taken longer to gain traction in academic discourse.

In 2019, there is another significant rise in both publications (4 total) and citations (25 total citations), which reflects renewed academic productivity and influence. Similarly, 2023 also exhibits strong performance, with 2 publications generating 33 citations, demonstrating that recent works are rapidly being recognized within the academic community. Lastly, even the most recent year in the dataset, 2024, already shows an impact, with 2 publications generating 10 citations, indicating early recognition of these publications and the potential for further growth in citation counts as the research gains more visibility.

Highly cited documents. As illustrated in Table 4 below, illustrated set of 40 articles that serves as a foundational body of work for the scoping review, reflecting the diversity of approaches, geographic contexts, and key topics in the study of music and cultural tourism. These articles will provide valuable insights for identifying trends, challenges, and opportunities within the existing literature, which will be explored in more depth in the discussion section.

Themes from selected documents. Table 5 below summarizes themes emerged from the 40 articles included in the scoping

Table 4 Top 40 highly cited articles.

No.	Authors	Title	Source Title	Cites	Cites per Year
1	Aoyama (2009)	Artists, tourists, and the state: Cultural tourism and the flamenco industry in Andalusia, Spain	International Journal of Urban and Regional Research	72	4.50
2	Mason (2004)	Sound and meaning in Aboriginal tourism	Annals of Tourism Research	56	2.67
3	Bærenholdt & Haldrup (2006)	Mobile networks and place making in cultural tourism. Staging viking ships and rock music in Roskilde	European Urban and Regional Studies	56	2.95
4	Xie et al. (2007)	Gazing the hood: Hip-Hop as tourism attraction	Tourism Management	51	2.83
5	Herrero et al. (2012)	Who Pays More for a Cultural Festival, Tourists or Locals? A Certainty Analysis of a Contingent Valuation Application	International Journal of Tourism Research	50	3.85
6	McCarthy (2012)	From fishing and factories to cultural tourism: The role of social entrepreneurs in the construction of a new institutional field	Entrepreneurship and Regional Development	44	3.38
7	Dunbar-Hall (2001)	Culture, tourism and cultural tourism: boundaries and frontiers in performances of balinese music and dance	Journal of Intercultural Studies	38	1.58
8	Lashua et al. (2013)	Popular music, psychogeography, place identity and tourism: The case of Sheffield	Tourist Studies	38	3.45
9	McMorland & Mactaggart (2007)	Traditional Scottish music events: Native scots attendance motivations	Event Management	23	1.28
10	Brown & Geddes (2007)	Resorts, culture, and music: The Cape Breton tourism cluster	Tourism Economics	21	1.17
11	Smith et al. (2022)	The changing nature of the cultural tourist: motivations, profiles and experiences of cultural tourists in Budapest	Journal of Tourism and Cultural Change	21	7.00
12	Soria et al. (2014)	Emporda music festivals as tourism diversification tools	International Journal of Event and Festival Management	15	1.36
13	Folgado-Fernández et al. (2021)	Tourist's rational and emotional engagement across events: a multi-event integration view	International Journal of Contemporary Hospitality Management	15	3.75
14	Lee et al. (2022)	Sustainable Development Assessment of Cultural and Creative Industries in Casino Cities: A Case Study of Macao	Sustainability (Switzerland)	14	4.67
15	Grant (2019)	Climate Justice and Cultural Sustainability: The Case of Etütung (Vanuatu Women's Water Music)	Asia Pacific Journal of Anthropology	13	2.17
16	Mallette et al. (2018)	Segmenting the audience attending a military music festival	International Journal of Event and Festival Management	10	1.43
17	García-García et al. (2023)	Flamenco experience in Córdoba, Spain: estimating tourist profiles by multilayer perceptron's artificial neural networks	Journal of Cultural Heritage Management and Sustainable Development	10	5.00
18	Gligorijevic (2014)	World Music festivals and tourism: a case study of Serbia's Guca trumpet festival	International Journal of Cultural Policy	10	0.91
19	Brown (2009)	Island tourism marketing: Music and culture	International Journal of Culture, Tourism and Hospitality Research	10	0.63
20	Io (2019)	Collaboration between practitioners and public agencies in preserving and promoting musical heritage in Macao	Journal of Heritage Tourism	8	1.33
21	Moscardo et al. (2009)	The importance of networks in special interest tourism: Case studies of music tourism in Australia	International Journal of Tourism Policy	8	0.50
22	Kazemiyeh et al. (2018)	Investigation of rural tourism in East Azarbaijan province of Iran utilizing SWOT model and Delphi technique	Journal of Agricultural Science and Technology	7	0.78
23	Qiao et al. (2009)	A study on inbound tourists' evaluations of chinese traditional cultural performances as tourism Products—The case of the zen music shaolin grand ceremony	Journal of China Tourism Research	6	0.38
24	Chigora et al. (2020)	Towards Establishing Zimbabwe Tourism Destination Brand Equity Variables through Sustainable Community Involvement	African Journal of Hospitality, Tourism and Leisure	6	1.20

Table 4 (continued)

No.	Authors	Title	Source Title	Cites	Cites per Year
25	Khoo & Noonan (2011)	Going for gold: Creating a Chinese heritage festival in Nundle, New South Wales	Continuum	6	0.43
26	Forga (2014)	Las relaciones sociales y las motivaciones paraasistral festival de música de peralada	Boletín de la Asociación de Geógrafos Españoles	5	0.45
27	Huang & Chiao (2018)	Innovative research on the development of game-based tourism information services using component-based software engineering	Advances in Science, Technology and Engineering Systems	5	0.71
28	Cashman (2014)	Music and (Touristic) Meaning on Cruise Ships: The Musicscape of the MV Carnival Paradise as a Semiotic Tourism Product	IASPM Journal	5	0.45
29	Henshall (2012)	Delta blues at the crossroads: Cultural tourism and the economic revitalization of downtown Clarksdale, Mississippi	Thesis Eleven	5	0.38
30	Argyriadis (2008)	Speculators and santuristas: The development of Afro-Cuban cultural tourism and the accusation of religious commercialism	Tourist Studies	4	0.24
31	Besana & Esposito (2019)	Fundraising, social media and tourism in American symphony orchestras and opera houses	Business Economics	4	0.67
32	Ozdemir (2011)	Traveler images of cities or buses dressed up the images of city: [Kentlerin gezgin imgeleri veya kent imgeleri giydirilen otobüsler]	Milli Folklor	4	0.29
33	Ryan (2015)	Re-branding Tasmania: MONA and the altering of local reputation and identity	Tourist Studies	4	0.44
34	Lestari & Yusra (2022)	Identifying Tourism Potentials of Ethno-Cultural Attractions in Lombok	Sustainability (Switzerland)	4	1.33
35	Siswantoyo & Kuswarsantyo (2017)	Pencak silat dance; Developing local genius values in the perspective of tourism business opportunity	International Journal of Applied Business and Economic Research	3	0.38
36	Hemmati & Abbasi (2013)	Creative tourism entrepreneurship in Rasht	Advances in Environmental Biology	2	0.17
37	Fernandes (2013)	Soundscapes and territory: World music in territorial marketing	Geojournal of Tourism and Geosites	2	0.17
38	Aeschliman (2018)	Cultural tourism as pilgrimage	Semiotica	1	0.14
39	Binson et al. (2024)	Keeping It Alive - Mapping Bangkok's Diverse Living Culture	Journal of Urban Culture Research	1	1.00
40	McKerrell & Hornabrook (2022)	Mobilizing traditional music in the rural creative economy of Argyll and Bute, Scotland	Creative Industries Journal	1	0.33

Source: Generated by the author(s) using biblioMagika® (Ahmi, 2024)

Table 5 Emerging themes from selected documents.						
No.	Authors & Year	Title	Aim/Purpose	Study design	Field of study	Themes
1	Aoyama (2009)	Artists, tourists, and the state: Cultural tourism and the flamenco industry in Andalusia, Spain	Explore the role of music (flamenco) in promoting cultural tourism in Andalusia	Case study (qualitative)	Cultural Tourism	Cultural identity, globalization
2	Mason (2004)	Sound and meaning in Aboriginal tourism	Understand the role of sound/music in reshaping cultural identities in Aboriginal tourism	Ethnographic case study	Aboriginal Tourism	Cultural preservation, identity
3	Bærenholdt & Haldrup (2006)	Mobile networks and place making in cultural tourism. Staging viking ships and rock music in Roskilde	Analyze the staging of Viking ships and rock music to create place identity	Case study	Cultural Tourism	Place-making, tourism
4	Xie et al. (2007)	Gazing the hood: Hip-Hop as tourism attraction	Investigate hip-hop culture as a tourism product	Case study	Urban Cultural Tourism	Hip-hop culture, authenticity
5	Herrero et al. (2012)	Who Pays More for a Cultural Festival, Tourists or Locals? A Certainty Analysis of a Contingent Valuation Application	Compare festival pricing between tourists and locals	Contingent valuation study	Festival Tourism	Tourist behavior
6	McCarthy (2012)	From fishing and factories to cultural tourism: The role of social entrepreneurs in the construction of a new institutional field	Examine the shift from industrial to cultural tourism driven by entrepreneurs	Case study	Cultural Economics	Cultural entrepreneurship
7	Dunbar-Hall (2001)	Culture, tourism and cultural tourism: boundaries and frontiers in performances of balinese music and dance	Explore the intersection of tourism and traditional Balinese performances	Comparative study	Cultural Performances	Cultural boundaries
8	Lashua et al. (2013)	Popular music, psychogeography, place identity and tourism: The case of Sheffield	Investigate how popular music shapes Sheffield's tourism identity	Qualitative study	Music Tourism	Place identity, music heritage
9	McMorland & Mactaggart (2007)	Traditional Scottish music events: Native scots attendance motivations	Examine motivations for attending Scottish music events	Survey and focus groups	Music Events	Visitor motivations
10	Brown & Geddes (2007)	Resorts, culture, and music: The Cape Breton tourism cluster	Assess the role of music in tourism development in Cape Breton	Case study	Music Tourism	Regional development
11	(Smith et al., 2022)	The changing nature of the cultural tourist: motivations, profiles and experiences of cultural tourists in Budapest	Analyze evolving tourist motivations in cultural tourism	Mixed-methods study	Cultural Tourism	Tourist motivations
12	Soria et al. (2014)	Emporda music festivals as tourism diversification tools	Explore the economic impact of music festivals on tourism	Case study	Festival Tourism	Economic diversification
13	Folgado-Fernández et al. (2021)	Tourist's rational and emotional engagement across events: a multi-event integration view	Investigate tourist engagement in multiple cultural events	Quantitative study	Festival Tourism	Tourist engagement

Table 5 (continued)

No.	Authors & Year	Title	Aim/Purpose	Study design	Field of study	Themes
14	Lee et al. (2022)	Sustainable Development Assessment of Cultural and Creative Industries in Casino Cities: A Case Study of Macao	Examine the sustainable development of cultural industries through tourism in Macao	Case study	Cultural and Creative Tourism	Sustainability, cultural tourism
15	Grant (2019)	Climate Justice and Cultural Sustainability: The Case of Etütung (Vanuatu Women's Water Music)	Investigate the link between climate justice and cultural tourism	Case study	Cultural Tourism	Cultural sustainability
16	Mallette et al. (2018)	Segmenting the audience attending a military music festival	Explore audience segmentation in military music festivals	Survey analysis	Music Tourism	Audience segmentation
17	García-García et al. (2023)	Flamenco experience in Córdoba, Spain: estimating tourist profiles by multilayer perceptron's artificial neural networks	Use AI to estimate tourist behavior in music festivals	AI-based study	Music Tourism	Technological innovation
18	Gligorijevic (2014)	World Music festivals and tourism: a case study of Serbia's Guca trumpet festival	Investigate the globalization of music festivals in Serbia	Case study	Festival Tourism	Globalization, cultural heritage
19	Brown (2009)	Island tourism marketing: Music and culture	Analyze the role of music in island tourism marketing	Case study	Island Tourism	Cultural tourism
20	Io (2019)	Collaboration between practitioners and public agencies in preserving and promoting musical heritage in Macao	Investigate preservation of musical heritage through public and private collaboration	Qualitative analysis	Music Heritage	Cultural preservation
21	Moscardo et al. (2009)	The importance of networks in special interest tourism: Case studies of music tourism in Australia	Explore how networks facilitate music tourism	Case study	Music Tourism	Networks, regional tourism
22	Kazemiyeh et al. (2018)	Investigation of rural tourism in East Azarbaijan province of Iran utilizing SWOT model and Delphi technique	Examine the role of music in rural tourism development	SWOT & Delphi techniques	Rural Tourism	Rural development
23	Qiao et al. (2009)	A study on inbound tourists' evaluations of chinese traditional cultural performances as tourism Products—The case of the zen music shaojin grand ceremony	Analyze tourist perceptions of Chinese cultural performances	Survey analysis	Cultural Performances	Tourist experience
24	Chigora et al. (2020)	Towards Establishing Zimbabwe Tourism Destination Brand Equity Variables through Sustainable Community Involvement	Investigate how local music contributes to brand equity in Zimbabwe tourism	Mixed-methods	Cultural Tourism	Brand equity, community engagement
25	Khoo & Noonan (2011)	Going for gold: Creating a Chinese heritage festival in Nundle, New South Wales	Investigate the creation and impact of a Chinese heritage music festival	Case study	Festival Tourism	Heritage tourism

Table 5 (continued)

No.	Authors & Year	Title	Aim/Purpose	Study design	Field of study	Themes
26	Forga (2014)	Las relaciones sociales y las motivaciones paraasistral festival de musica de peralada	Explore the social motivations behind festival attendance	Survey & interviews	Festival Tourism	Social networks
27	Huang & Chiao (2018)	Innovative research on the development of game-based tourism information services using component-based software engineering	Examine the potential for music-based tourism games	Mixed methods	Music Tourism	Innovation, digital tourism
28	Cashman (2014)	Music and (Touristic) Meaning on Cruise Ships: The Musicscape of the MV Carnival Paradise as a Semiotic Tourism Product	Investigate how cruise ship music contributes to the touristic experience	Ethnographic study	Cruise Tourism	Music, cruise tourism
29	Henshall (2012)	Delta blues at the crossroads: Cultural tourism and the economic revitalization of downtown Clarksdale, Mississippi	Explore the role of Delta blues music in economic revitalization through tourism	Case study	Cultural Tourism	Economic revitalization
30	Argyriadis (2008)	Speculators and santuristas: The development of Afro-Cuban cultural tourism and the accusation of religious commercialism	Examine the role of music in Afro-Cuban tourism and the debate around religious commercialization	Ethnographic study	Cultural Tourism	Music commercialization
31	Besana & Esposito (2019)	Fundraising, social media and tourism in American symphony orchestras and opera houses	Investigate how music tourism supports fundraising for symphony orchestras	Survey analysis	Music Tourism	Fundraising, tourism
32	Ozdemir (2011)	Traveler images of cities or buses dressed up the images of city: [Kentlerin gezgin imgeleri veya kent imgeleri giydirilen otobüsler]	Investigate how cities use cultural music for tourism branding	Mixed methods	Music Tourism	Cultural branding
33	Ryan (2015)	Re-branding Tasmania: MONA and the altering of local reputation and identity	Examine how music events contribute to re-branding Tasmania as a tourism destination	Case study	Cultural Tourism	Branding, local identity
34	Lestari & Yusra (2022)	Identifying Tourism Potentials of Ethno-Cultural Attractions in Lombok	Investigate how music contributes to cultural attractions in Lombok	Field study	Cultural Tourism	Ethno-cultural tourism
35	Siswantoyo & Kuswarsantyo (2017)	Pencak silat dance: Developing local genius values in the perspective of tourism business opportunity	Investigate traditional dance and music as business opportunities in tourism	Case study	Cultural Tourism	Cultural business opportunity
36	Hemmati & Abbasi (2013)	Creative tourism entrepreneurship in Rasht	Explore the role of music and cultural entrepreneurship in Rasht	Case study	Creative Tourism	Cultural entrepreneurship

Table 5 (continued)						
No.	Authors & Year	Title	Aim/Purpose	Study design	Field of study	Themes
37	Fernandes (2013)	Soundscapes and territory: World music in territorial marketing	Examine how world music influences territorial marketing strategies	Ethnographic field study	Music Tourism	Territorial branding
38	Aeschliman (2018)	Cultural tourism as pilgrimage	Investigate the role of religious music in cultural tourism as pilgrimage	Comparative study	Religious Music Tourism	Pilgrimage, religious music
39	Binson et al. (2024)	Keeping It Alive - Mapping Bangkok's Diverse Living Culture	Explore how traditional music sustains Bangkok's cultural identity and tourism	Case study	Cultural Tourism	Cultural sustainability
40	McKerrell & Hornabrook (2022)	Mobilizing traditional music in the rural creative economy of Argyll and Bute, Scotland	Examine the role of traditional music in rural creative economy development	Ethnographic study	Rural Cultural Tourism	Creative economy, traditional music

review. It provides an overview of each study’s authors, title, aim, study design, field of study, and themes, offering a structured look at how the relationship between music and cultural tourism is explored across different contexts. The matrix serves as a foundational tool for understanding the scope of the literature and will inform the detailed analysis and discussion in later sections.

Discussion

This study provides a comprehensive exploration of the intersection between music tourism, cultural preservation, economic development, tourist experiences, and technological innovation. Through a scoping review and bibliometric analysis of 40 highly cited articles, the findings reveal the opportunities and challenges in leveraging music tourism to foster regional identity, economic growth, and technological advancement while addressing ethical and cultural concerns.

The discussion synthesizes key themes, including cultural preservation and identity, economic and ethical impacts, tourist motivations and experiences, and digital and technological innovations. These themes are critically analyzed to highlight their theoretical and practical implications. Additionally, this section addresses gaps in the literature, such as regional disparities and the long-term sustainability of music tourism, while offering directions for future research.

Cultural preservation and identity. Music tourism plays a pivotal role in preserving cultural heritage and reinforcing regional identities, though its application varies significantly across contexts. Aoyama (2009) and Dunbar-Hall (2001) demonstrate how music traditions like flamenco in Andalusia and Balinese performances adapt to global audiences while maintaining authenticity. Fernandes (2013) emphasizes how world music contributes to territorial branding, underscoring music’s dual role in preserving heritage and promoting regional identity.

Grant (2019) introduces an innovative perspective by linking cultural preservation with climate justice, using the Etétung water music of Vanuatu as an example of how cultural tourism can address global challenges like climate change. Similarly, urban contexts such as Bangkok (Binson et al., 2024) and rural examples like East Azarbaijan (Kazemiyeh et al., 2018) reveal how diverse settings adapt music tourism to strengthen cultural identities.

However, the tension between preservation and commodification persists. Ryan (2015) illustrates how MONA’s music events in Tasmania rebranded the region while fostering local pride, but Argyriadis (2008) critiques the commercialization of Afro-Cuban religious music, warning of the risk to cultural authenticity. Xie et al. (2007) examine how the global rise of hip-hop tourism exemplifies this tension, where commercialization influences the authenticity tourists seek. These examples underscore the need for sustainable tourism practices that prioritize cultural integrity and balance preservation with innovation. These examples highlight the complex interplay between preservation and commodification, emphasizing the need for sustainable tourism practices that prioritize cultural integrity. By understanding these dynamics, stakeholders can develop strategies that not only protect heritage but also enhance its value for future generations.

Economic and ethical impacts. Music tourism contributes significantly to regional development, particularly through festivals and events that drive economic diversification. Gligorijevic (2014) highlights the Guca trumpet festival’s global appeal and economic benefits for Serbia’s local communities. Similarly, Herrero et al. (2012) demonstrate how festivals in Spain foster cultural engagement while generating economic returns. Brown & Geddes (2007) and McCarthy (2012) emphasize the stabilizing role of

music tourism in regions transitioning from industrial to cultural economies, such as Cape Breton.

New insights from Fan et al. (2022) reinforce the economic potential of integrating immersive technologies like AR/VR, which enhance tourist satisfaction and expand audience reach. García-García et al. (2023) show how AI-driven profiling can help tailor tourism offerings, improving economic outcomes by aligning experiences with audience preferences.

However, ethical challenges persist. Mason (2004) critiques how Aboriginal music tourism often reinforces stereotypes, while Fernandes (2013) warns of reducing world music to a marketing tool, stripping it of cultural significance. provides an alternative model, showcasing how public-private collaborations in Macao empower local communities to retain agency over their cultural expressions while benefiting economically. These examples underscore the importance of inclusive and equitable approaches to music tourism.

Tourist motivations and experiences. Understanding tourist motivations is critical for creating impactful music tourism experiences. McMorland & Mactaggart (2007) reveal that native Scots are motivated by heritage and cultural identity when attending traditional music events. Lashua et al. (2013) explore how Sheffield's music heritage shapes visitor experiences, creating a sense of place and connection.

Social interaction also drives tourist behavior. Forga (2014) highlights how Spain's Peralada Festival fosters community bonding, while Mallette et al. (2018) demonstrate how patriotism motivates attendees of military music festivals. These findings suggest the importance of segmenting audiences to tailor tourism experiences to specific motivations.

Emerging technologies further influence motivations. Fan et al. (2022) reveal that AR/VR enhances tourist engagement by offering immersive, sensory-rich experiences, appealing to younger, tech-savvy audiences. However, gaps remain in understanding how motivations vary across demographics, particularly among underserved populations or those hesitant to embrace digital innovations.

Digital and technological innovations. Digital tools like AR, VR, and AI are reshaping music tourism, offering immersive, interactive, and personalized experiences. Hong & Wu (2022) highlight an AR application in Guizhou, China, designed to educate tourists about traditional musical instruments while strengthening their connection to the region's cultural identity. Similarly, Boletsis & Chasanidou, (2018) developed AudioNear, an audio AR system providing real-time cultural context, enhancing urban tourism experiences.

Fan et al. (2022) show that AR/VR technologies significantly improve tourist satisfaction through sensory engagement, expanding the accessibility of music tourism. However, as Siddiqui et al. (2022) caution, over-reliance on digital tools risks losing the emotional connection of in-person experiences, particularly in regions lacking the infrastructure to implement these technologies equitably.

Additionally, Lashua et al. (2013) warn that reducing cultural heritage to a digital product may oversimplify narratives, risking cultural authenticity. Future research should explore how digital tools can complement traditional music tourism while addressing barriers to equitable implementation and long-term sustainability.

Conclusion

This study synthesizes insights from 40 highly cited articles to provide a comprehensive exploration of music tourism's

intersection with cultural preservation, economic development, tourist experiences, and technological innovation. By analysing the multifaceted dimensions of music tourism, this research highlights its potential to foster regional identity, drive economic growth, and address global challenges, while also identifying critical gaps and opportunities for future research.

Key contributions. Music tourism emerges as a powerful tool for preserving cultural heritage and reinforcing regional identities, as seen in its application across diverse settings such as rural East Azarbaijan, urban Sheffield, and Vanuatu. However, challenges such as commodification, cultural stereotyping, and the dilution of authenticity remain pressing concerns. The findings underscore the importance of sustainable and inclusive tourism practices that prioritize cultural integrity while navigating the tensions between preservation and commercialization. Economic development is another significant outcome of music tourism, particularly through festivals and events that stimulate local economies. Examples like Serbia's Guca trumpet festival and Spain's regional music festivals demonstrate how music tourism contributes to both economic diversification and cultural engagement.

Yet, ethical challenges, such as equitable representation and the inclusion of marginalized communities, call for frameworks that balance economic growth with cultural sensitivity and authenticity. Digital innovations, including AR, VR, and AI, are revolutionizing music tourism by offering immersive and accessible experiences. These technologies present opportunities to enhance tourist engagement, expand accessibility, and preserve cultural narratives in digital formats. However, their integration must be carefully managed to ensure they complement rather than replace traditional tourism experiences, preserving authenticity and addressing barriers to equitable adoption.

Implications for theory and practice. The findings contribute to the theoretical understanding of music tourism by linking it to broader concepts such as cultural identity, place branding, and sustainable tourism. Practically, they offer actionable insights for stakeholders in tourism management, cultural policy, and technology development. For example, public-private collaborations, as demonstrated in Macao, provide a sustainable model for balancing economic and cultural objectives.

Future directions. This study identifies several areas for further research. First, more attention is needed to understand the motivations of diverse demographic groups, including younger, tech-savvy audiences and those from underrepresented regions. Second, future research should explore the scalability and sustainability of digital innovations in music tourism, particularly in contexts with limited infrastructure or resources. Lastly, longitudinal studies are needed to assess the long-term impacts of music tourism on cultural preservation, community engagement, and economic development.

By addressing these gaps, future research can ensure that music tourism evolves as a sustainable and inclusive practice that balances preservation with innovation (Mazlan et al, 2024, 2025a, 2025b). This study serves as a foundation for advancing academic inquiry and guiding policymakers, practitioners, and communities in leveraging music tourism to create meaningful cultural and economic impacts.

Data availability

No datasets were generated or analysed during the current study.

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C.A.N.M: Conceptualization, Data Curation, Methodology, Writing - Original Draft, Visualization. M. H. A: Supervision, Project Administration, Writing - Review & Editing. N.S.N.H: Formal Analysis, Validation, Writing - Review & Editing. N. A. W: Resources, Investigation, Writing - Review & Editing.

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The authors declare no competing interests.

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